

A hard reboot should only be used as a last resort

Keep Your Battery Healthy

- ☑ Before the first use, charge the batteries for 12 hours or the minimum charge time, as mentioned in the manual.
- ☑ For daily use, charge the battery to capacity, then run the laptop on battery power until it is completely drained (for Ni-Cd or Ni-MH batteries, this prevents the memory effect) or almost drained. (For Li-ion batteries, this can help prevent overcharging).
- ☑ Don't leave your battery unused for long periods of time. Even if you use AC power most of the time, use the battery regularly to keep it in good condition. Switch off your AC adapter when the laptop is not in use. This prevents overcharging.

To extend battery life, you can try decreasing the LCD brightness while using your notebook. You can activate the 'Standby' and 'Hibernation' power-saving modes, too, for better battery life.

Battery Storage

- ☑ If you do not use your laptop for extended periods of time—a week or more—remove the battery pack from the laptop, but only after discharging it fully.
- ☑ The batteries should be stored in a cool dry place, removed from heat, humidity and dust as well as metal objects.

Use A Laptop Case

It is advisable to spend a couple of thousand rupees and get a sturdy carry-case for your laptop.

The case should ideally be hard from the outside and soft on the inside, while being a comfortable fit. It should be able to absorb shocks and carry your laptop accessories.

Keep Eatables Away

Obviously, no eating and drinking near or around your laptop. The least bit of water could short-circuit some sensitive laptop circuits, and render it useless.

No Hard Booting

You may sometimes be tempted to turn your laptop off by



simply holding down the power button until it powers down. Although quick, this method is harmful to the laptop and could cause data loss.

A hard reboot should only be used as a last resort. Sometimes this is inevitable,



for instance, when Windows hangs. But this should not be a regular practice.

General Tips

Shortcuts To Success

Create shortcuts to your most commonly used applications, folders and files on the desktop. This way, you can access them quickly. If you like your desktop clutter-free, you can also create custom toolbars in Windows XP.

To do this, right-click on the Windows taskbar, go to 'Toolbars' and click 'New Toolbar'. Next, choose the drive or folder you want to access using the toolbar. You can create different toolbars for different drives and folders.

This is especially useful for sales executives who want easy

access to presentations, proposals and other information they use on a day-to-day basis.

Clean Up The Junk

Uninstall applications you don't use. Apart from saving on disk space, you'll also prevent your notebook from slowing down.

Be resourceful—keep backups of the OS, drivers and commonly used applications on a secondary partition so you can do some re-installing on your own if you face any issues when travelling. Carry driver CDs and recovery disks.

Laptop Security

Don't Be A Jerk

Don't subject your laptop to jerks and shocks. This will help avoid damage to your hard drive. Preferably, power the notebook off before moving it from one place to another.

Dusty Notebooks Don't Impress

Protect your laptop from dust. Ensure vents are clean to enable good air flow.

Drinks And Laptops A No-No

Don't place any containers filled with beverages (hot or cold) near your notebook, to prevent accidental spills.

Power Saving Tips

Let Power Be Managed By The Pros

Set the device to switch off the LCD screen, and hard drive after fixed intervals of time.

Disconnect

External peripherals and accessories such as external optical drives, PC cards and USB keyboard lights draw power from the notebook. Disconnect such devices when not in use.

Suspend Your Notebook

Booting the notebook when it is not connected to a power source draws a lot of power from the battery.

Instead of shutting down your laptop in the middle of a meeting, choose the 'Suspend' mode if you wish to use it again after just a short interval. This will save battery and help you restart your work faster. ☑

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